

Bcho NAM Player

VST3 / AU Plugin Manual



VST3 / AU Plugin | Version 1.7.5

Complete reference for the plug-in. It shares its engine, its rack, its effects, its TONE3000 library and its presets with the standalone application, so this manual documents the plug-in in full and points at the standalone manual for the chapters that are identical.

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1. What the plug-in is

An **audio-effect** plug-in - not a MIDI instrument. It carries two complete and independent signal paths (L and R), each with BLOCK NAM 1, BLOCK NAM 2, a cabinet IR, an eight-effect rack with free ordering, gate, tone stack, master level, IR blend, IR volume, input and output gain, power, calibration and tuner.

Format	Platforms
VST3	Windows x64, macOS Intel and Apple Silicon, Linux x86_64
AU	macOS only

AAX is not included. Match the package to your DAW's process architecture.

2. Installing

Close the DAW first, and copy the **entire bundle**, not just the binary inside it.

System	Destination
Windows	C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3 (administrator permission may be required)
macOS VST3	~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3
macOS AU	~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components
Linux	~/.vst3

Start the DAW and rescan plug-ins. The effect appears as **Bcho NAM Player**.

macOS builds are ad-hoc signed, not notarized. If the host blocks the plug-in, review Privacy & Security and your host's own validation - do not disable system protection globally.

3. Your first track

1. Insert the plug-in as an **effect** on a mono or stereo audio track. 2. Select your guitar input in the DAW and enable monitoring. Avoid monitoring the same signal twice, through the interface and the DAW. 3. A new instance starts in **MONO** with every block disabled, so your dry signal passes through until you load a capture. POWER can mute the path. 4. Load a capture with **BROWSE LOCAL** or **TONE3000**, then a cabinet with **BROWSE IR**. 5. Set levels with INPUT GAIN, MASTER VOL and OUTPUT GAIN while watching the meters.

Driver, sample rate and buffer size belong to the DAW. The plug-in has no audio-device window.

4. Map of the editor



The plug-in editor in MONO

The layout is the standalone's, minus the parts a host owns:

- **Rack strip:** preset buttons, the eleven reorderable blocks, the tuner and its display, the tuning selector, the MONO / STEREO switch and the settings gear.
 - **Amplifier head:** Input VU, INPUT GAIN, INPUT CALI; the seven main knobs with the NAM and IR selectors above them; the NAM and IR browsers with the IR VOL fader; Output VU, OUTPUT GAIN and POWER.
 - **Cabinet:** the logo and two cones driven by the real output level.
- The editor is fully resizable and keeps its 1537 x 1023 proportions.

5. MONO, STEREO and the channel layout

The plug-in always presents a **stereo output**, even on a mono track, so both chains always have somewhere to go.

Mode	Behaviour
MONO	Only the left path runs. Its result is copied to both plug-in outputs
STEREO	Left path processes input channel 1 and feeds output 1; right path processes input channel 2 and feeds output 2

On a **mono track in STEREO**, both chains receive the same input signal, so one guitar drives two independent rigs.
On a **stereo track in STEREO**, the two input channels are processed separately.



The plug-in in STEREO: two rack rows, four NAM selectors, two IR selectors

The standalone's DUAL MONO / SPLIT L/R switch is not present: in a DAW you decide that with the track's own routing.

The L / R tabs beside the racks choose which path the shared controls edit; the NAM 1 L, NAM 2 L, NAM 1 R, NAM 2 R and IR L, IR R selectors work exactly as in the standalone - see Which control follows what.

6. Loading captures and cabinets

Identical to the standalone (chapter 8 and chapter 9):

- Choose the target block with the NAM selectors, then **BROWSE LOCAL**, the list, **TONE3000**, a double-click on the block, or drag and drop.
- **BROWSE IR** loads a .wav response; clicking the selected row again clears it and bypasses the IR block.
- Loading a valid file switches its block on. IR gain is never normalized.
- NAM A1, A2 Standard and A2 Nano are detected automatically.
- Hovering a NAM block or list row shows the capture information card.

Demonstration captures ship in the Mode ls folder beside the package but are never loaded automatically; find them with BROWSE LOCAL.

The DAW project stores **references** to your .nam and .wav files, not the files themselves. Keep them in place, or save .bnpp presets, which embed them.

7. Controls

Ranges, defaults and behaviour are the same as the standalone - see Amplifier controls, knob by knob.

In short: INPUT GAIN and OUTPUT GAIN ± 12 dB; GATE from OFF to a -80...0 dB threshold; BASS / MID / TREBLE / PRESENCE ± 12 dB at 70 Hz, 750 Hz, 4 kHz and 6 kHz following the selected NAM block; MASTER VOL ± 12 dB; IR BLEND 0-100 %; IR VOL -24...0 dB (default -12 dB) following the selected cabinet; POWER mutes the path. Drag a knob to change it, double-click to restore its default.

8. The rack and the eight effects

Identical to the standalone (chapter 7 and chapter 11): single click enables or bypasses, double-click opens the editor or the file chooser, drag reorders around the BLOCK NAM 2 and IR anchors, and the eye chooses which block the shared controls describe.

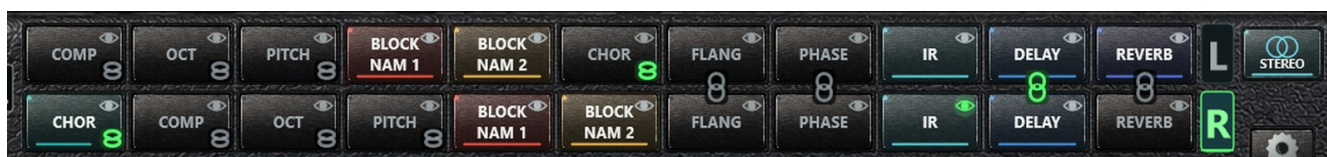


The effect editor

Compressor, octaver, pitch shifter, chorus, flanger, phaser, delay and reverb, each with three algorithms and six real-unit parameters. The full tables are in the standalone manual.

9. Linking effects between L and R

In STEREO the chain icon links an effect of L with the same effect of R, so one edit changes both. Green = linked, grey = not. When the two blocks share a column the icon sits on the seam between the rows; when they do not, it moves to the lower-right corner of both blocks.



Linked and unlinked pairs in the plug-in's two rack rows

Linked blocks share the algorithm and the six parameters; each keeps its own on/off switch and its own position. Linking two blocks that differ asks which side's settings to keep. BLOCK NAM 1, BLOCK NAM 2 and IR cannot be linked. **Links are saved in the DAW project.** Full description: standalone chapter 13.

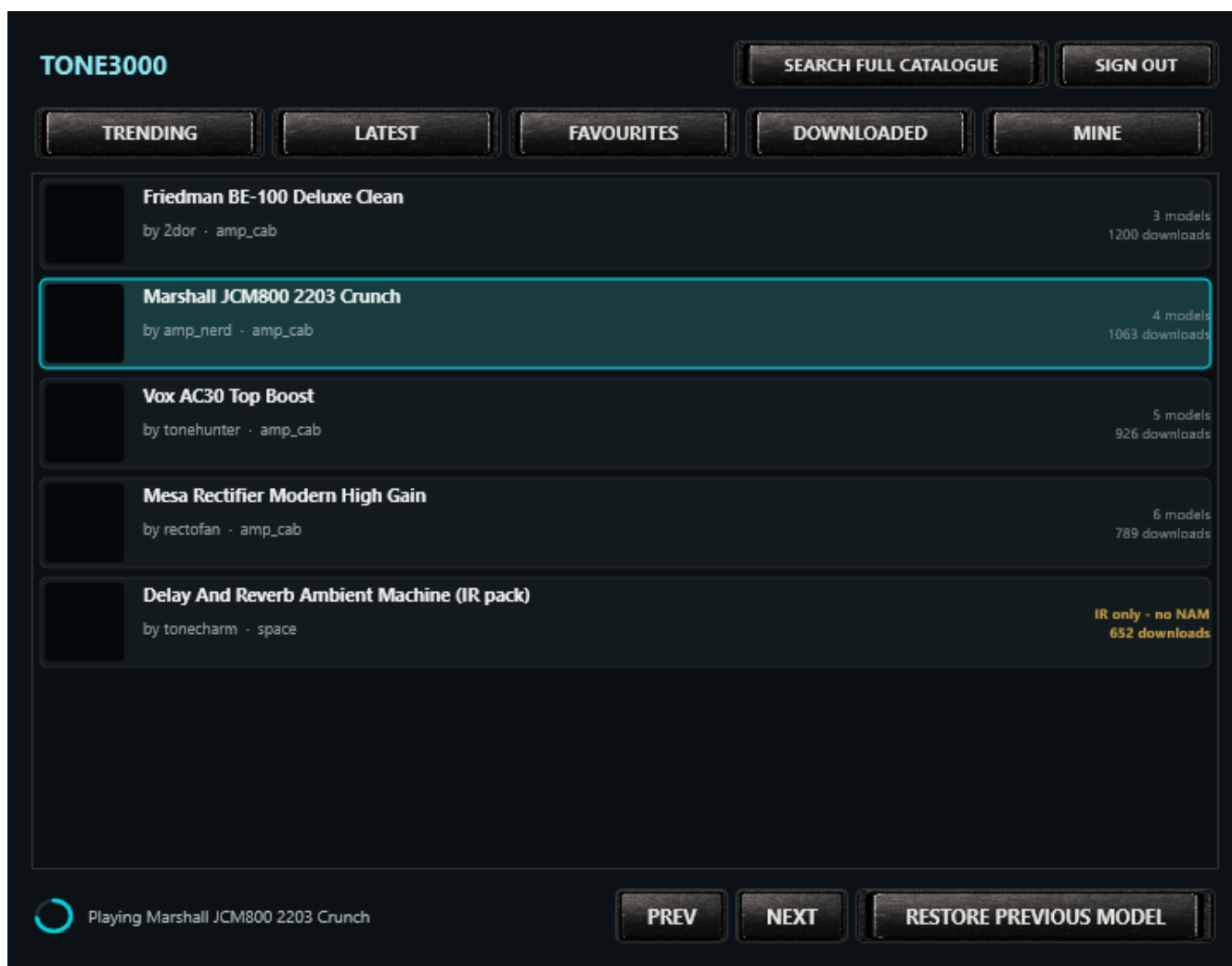
10. Tuner and Input Cali

TUNER works exactly as in the standalone: it listens to the untouched DI before the gate and the NAM blocks, covers roughly 65-700 Hz, reads centred within ± 5 cents, and offers STANDARD, DROP D, D STANDARD, Eb and OPEN G. Play one isolated string at a useful level.

INPUT CALI uses the engine's reference and the capture's `input_level_dbu` metadata (assuming +12 dBu when a capture has none), clamped to ± 24 dB. The plug-in does **not** expose the standalone's interface-reference slider, because the interface belongs to the DAW: for a specific hardware calibration, set the gain outside the plug-in or use the standalone.

11. TONE3000 inside the plug-in

The **TONE3000** button opens the same library window as the standalone.



The TONE3000 library

- Connect the account once; the encrypted refresh token is stored per user, so the plug-in never needs a browser again on that computer.

- TRENDING, LATEST, FAVOURITES, DOWNLOADED and MINE.

- **Selecting a row loads that capture into the current NAM block immediately;**

the rest of the tone downloads in the background, and picking another row cancels it. A tone already in your downloads loads instantly.

- Rows marked **IR only - no NAM** hold only impulse responses and are not auditioned.

- **RESTORE PREVIOUS MODEL** puts back what the block held before the window was opened; closing the window keeps the last audition.

- **SEARCH FULL CATALOGUE** opens TONE3000's own picker inside the plug-in; when you choose a tone the picker closes by itself and the download starts.

On Windows the embedded browser uses WebView2. Inside a DAW the plug-in stores its WebView2 data in a per-user folder, so a host installed in Program Files never blocks it. If WebView2 is missing, the plug-in offers an official Microsoft download or your external browser and installs nothing automatically. Full detail: standalone chapter 16.

12. Projects, presets and automation

The DAW project stores everything about the instance: both paths, every control, the file references, rack order, algorithms, parameters, bypass states, the L/R links, and MONO/STEREO.

Reopening a project re-loads the saved NAM, pedal NAM and IR of **both** paths into the engine with their saved on/off states - whatever order the host uses to restore the state and prepare audio, and with the editor closed. Project restore, capture changes and audio re-initialisation (a sample-rate or buffer-size change) all fade in from silence, so nothing clicks.

.bnpp **presets**. SAVE PRESET writes a portable archive for the **selected path** with its BLOCK NAM 1, BLOCK NAM 2, IR and settings embedded and checked with SHA-256; LOAD PRESET replaces that path. Share both paths as two presets; use the project to recall the whole instance. A two-path standalone preset loads its left-path representation into the selected plug-in path.

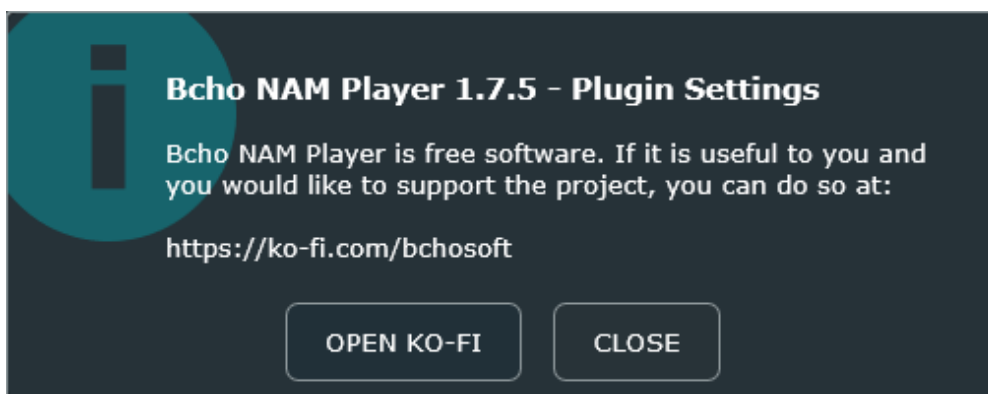
Automation. The host can automate the published parameters, per path:

Parameter	Per path
Input Gain, Gate, Bass, Mid, Treble, Presence, Master Vol	L_ and R_
NAM 1 Bass, NAM 1 Mid, NAM 1 Treble, NAM 1 Presence	L_ and R_
IR Blend, IR Cabinet Volume, Output Gain	L_ and R_
Power, Input Cali, Tuner	L_ and R_
Stereo (MONO / STEREO)	one, global

Rack order, effect algorithms and effect parameters are part of the saved state, not host automation. Loading a file is a load, not a continuous parameter.

13. Settings and support

The gear opens a short window with the version and a link to support the project.



Plug-in settings

14. Differences from the standalone

The standalone has	The plug-in
Audio Setup: driver, interface, channels, sample rate, buffer	The DAW owns all of it
Physical MAIN / PRE / DI / WET output routing	Route inside the DAW
DUAL MONO / SPLIT L/R input switch	Decided by the track's routing
Interface input reference slider for Input Cali	Not exposed; calibrate outside or use the standalone
Eleven selectable skins	Always Astra / Obsidian
Its own saved session between launches	State comes from the host project
Update checking	Not included

Everything else - engine, rack, effects, links, tuner, browsers, TONE3000, information card, .bnpp presets - is the same code.

15. Troubleshooting

Symptom	What to check
Not listed after scanning	Folder, format and architecture match the host; then rescan
No audio	Track input, monitoring, POWER, and the DAW's own routing
Dry sound only	A capture is loaded and its block is lit; a fully bypassed chain passes dry audio
One side silent in STEREO	The DAW must actually feed both channels; on a mono track both chains get the same input
Missing files after moving a project	Restore the .nam / .wav locations, or load your .bnpp presets
Dropouts	Raise the buffer and lower CPU load; four NAM blocks across two paths is demanding
Empty TONE3000 window	Account, network, or WebView2 on Windows; or use the external browser
macOS host rejects it	Review host validation and system permissions; ad-hoc signing is not notarization
The DAW process stayed alive after closing a project	A plug-in unload deadlock fixed in 1.7.5. End the leftover process once from the task manager and update the plug-in

16. Technical specifications

Item	Value
Plug-in type	Audio effect (no MIDI)
Bus layout	Mono or stereo input, always stereo output
Signal paths	2 independent (L / R)
NAM blocks	2 per path; IR 1 per path; 8 effects per path
Sample rates / buffers	Whatever the host provides; oversized host buffers are split internally
NAM architectures	A1, A2 Standard, A2 Nano - automatic
Start-up / re-prepare fade	60 ms from silence
NAM change fade	15 ms out, silence until the new capture is installed, 20 ms in
IR change fade	12 ms crossfade
Editor	1537 x 1023 native, resizable, proportional

17. Integrity and licences

Check ZIP hashes against SHA256SUMS.txt and read THIRD_PARTY_NOTICES.md (JUICE and Neural Amp Modeler Core). Respect the licences of the captures and impulse responses you use or share inside presets. These manuals do not imply certification in every DAW; each host and system combination deserves a practical check.